

CLAUDIA CHATTERLEY

Voice-to-Text for Claude Cowork & macOS
Speak instead of type. 3x faster. Zero cognitive load.

User Manual

Version 0.1.0

Written so anyone can follow along — even a sixth-grader.

By Severin Sorensen

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1. What Is Claudia Chatterley?

Claudia Chatterley is a small program that lets you talk to your computer instead of typing. You click a microphone button, speak out loud in your normal voice, and your words appear as typed text in whatever app you're using — Claude Cowork, a web browser, a note-taking app, anything.

Why does this matter? Research shows that speaking is 3 to 3.5 times faster than typing. When you type, your brain has to do two things at once: think about what to say AND move your fingers on the keyboard. When you speak, your brain only has to think about what to say. That frees up your creativity.

Claudia runs entirely on your Mac. Your voice never leaves your computer (unless you choose the optional cloud mode). It's free, open source, and private.

Think of it this way:

Claudia is like having a really fast, really accurate note-taker sitting next to you. You talk, she types. Then you look at what she typed, fix anything if needed, and press Enter.

2. What You Need (Requirements)

Claudia needs a few things to run. The good news: the installer (Chapter 3) handles all of this for you automatically. You just need:

Requirement	What It Is	Do I Already Have It?
A Mac computer	macOS 12 or newer. Apple Silicon (M1/M2/M3/M4) is best.	Click the Apple menu > About This Mac.
Homebrew	A free tool that installs other tools on your Mac. Think of it as an App Store for developer tools.	Open Terminal, type: <code>brew --version</code> If it says "command not found" — you don't have it. That's OK!
Python 3.10 or newer	A programming language. Your Mac probably has Python 3.9, which is too old. The installer adds 3.12 without touching your old one.	Open Terminal, type: <code>python3 --version</code> If it says 3.9 or lower, the installer will fix it.
portaudio	A small helper that lets Claudia hear your microphone.	The installer handles this automatically.

Don't worry if you're missing things!

Most Macs are missing Homebrew and have an older Python. The setup script in Chapter 3

checks for each item and installs whatever is missing. It asks your permission before installing anything.

How to open Terminal

Terminal is an app that lets you type commands to your Mac. Find it at: Applications > Utilities > Terminal. Or press Cmd+Space to open Spotlight search, type "Terminal", and press Enter.

3. Installation — Step by Step

There are three ways to install Claudia. We recommend Option A for most people — it handles everything, even if your Mac is brand new and has nothing installed yet.

Option A: The Smart Installer (Recommended)

This single command checks your entire Mac and installs everything Claudia needs. It will ask your permission before installing each piece.

Step 1: Open Terminal (Applications > Utilities > Terminal).

Step 2: Copy and paste this entire line, then press Enter:

```
curl -sSL https://raw.githubusercontent.com/severinsorensen/claudia-chatterley/main/setup.sh | bash
```

Step 3: The script will walk you through each step:

What It Checks	If Missing, It Will...
Homebrew	Ask to install it. You'll need to enter your Mac password. This takes 2–5 minutes.
Python 3.10+	Ask to install Python 3.12 via Homebrew. Your old Python 3.9 stays untouched. Takes about 1 minute.
portaudio	Install it automatically via Homebrew. Takes a few seconds.
Claudia itself	Download and install the Claudia Chatterley program. Takes about 1 minute.

When it finishes, you'll see a green checkmark and instructions for the next steps.

What if I see “command not found: brew” after Homebrew installs?

Close your Terminal window completely (Cmd+Q), open a new one, and run the setup command again. Homebrew sometimes needs a fresh Terminal window to be recognized.

Option B: Install from GitHub (For Developers)

If you want to see the code or help improve Claudia:

Step 1: Download the code from GitHub:

```
git clone https://github.com/severinsorensen/claudia-chatterley.git
```

Step 2: Go into the project folder:

```
cd claudia-chatterley
```

Step 3: Run the installer from inside the folder:

```
chmod +x setup.sh && ./setup.sh
```

This runs the same smart installer, but uses the local copy of the code instead of downloading it.

Option C: Manual Install (Advanced)

If you already have Homebrew and Python 3.10+, you can skip the setup script:

```
brew install portaudio && pip3 install claudia-chatterley
```

First-Time Download

The first time you run Claudia, it will download a “Whisper” speech model (about 140 MB). This only happens once. After that, everything runs instantly from your computer.

4. Giving Claudia Permission

Your Mac protects you by asking permission before any program can control the keyboard or use the microphone. Claudia needs two permissions:

Permission 1: Accessibility (Required)

This lets Claudia paste text into other apps by simulating a Cmd+V keystroke.

Step 1: Open System Settings (click the Apple menu at the top-left of your screen).

Step 2: Click Privacy & Security in the sidebar.

Step 3: Click Accessibility.

Step 4: Click the + button.

Step 5: Find and add Terminal (in Applications > Utilities > Terminal).

Step 6: Make sure the toggle next to Terminal is turned ON (blue).

Using a different terminal?

If you use iTerm, Warp, or another terminal app, add that app instead of Terminal. The key is to add whatever app you use to run the claudia command.

Permission 2: Microphone (Automatic)

The first time Claudia tries to listen to your microphone, macOS will show a pop-up asking for permission. Just click Allow. You only have to do this once.

5. Starting Claudia

Open Terminal and type:

```
claudia
```

You will see a welcome banner and two things will appear:

- **A microphone icon in your menu bar** (the strip at the top of your screen, near the clock). It looks like a small microphone symbol.
- **A floating microphone button** on the left side of your screen. This is a small, round, gray circle. You can drag it anywhere you like.

Claudia is now running and ready to listen whenever you click the microphone.

To stop Claudia

Press Ctrl+C in the Terminal window, or click the menubar icon and choose Quit Claudia.

6. How to Use It (The Fun Part)

Using Claudia takes four simple steps:

Step 1: Click the floating microphone button. It turns red, which means Claudia is listening.

Step 2: Speak out loud in your normal voice. Talk at a natural pace, just like you would talk to a friend. Claudia will pick up everything you say.

Step 3: Click the microphone button again. It turns blue for a moment (that means Claudia is turning your speech into text), then turns green (done!).

Step 4: Your words appear as text in whatever app had focus — Cowork, Chrome, a text editor, anything. Look at the text. Fix any mistakes if you want. Then press Enter to send it.

Pro Tip

Before you click the mic, click once on the text box where you want the text to appear. Claudia pastes into whatever window is active when it finishes transcribing. If you're using Cowork, click the Cowork input box first, then click the mic.

Important

Do NOT click away from your target app while Claudia is transcribing (while the button is blue). The text will be pasted into whatever window is in front when transcription finishes.

7. The Microphone Button Colors

The floating button changes color to tell you what's happening:

Color	What It Means	What You Should Do
Gray	Claudia is idle and ready.	Click to start recording.
Red	Claudia is listening to you.	Speak! Click again when done.
Blue	Claudia is transcribing your words.	Wait a moment. Don't click away.
Green (brief flash)	Done! Text has been pasted.	Review the text, edit if needed.

When Claudia is recording (red), the button pulses slightly with your voice — the louder you speak, the bigger the pulse. This is a handy way to confirm your microphone is working.

You will also hear a short chime sound when transcription is complete. You can turn this off in the settings (see Chapter 10).

8. Choosing a Whisper Model

Claudia uses a program called Whisper to turn your voice into text. Whisper comes in different sizes. Bigger models are more accurate but slower. Smaller models are faster but might make more mistakes.

Model Name	Download Size	Speed	Accuracy
tiny	39 MB	Very fast	Basic — good for quick notes
base (default)	140 MB	Fast	Good — best everyday choice
small	461 MB	Medium	Better — for important docs
medium	1.5 GB	Slower	Great — professional quality
large-v3	3 GB	Slowest	Best — maximum accuracy

The default model (base) is a great choice for most people. To switch models, stop Claudia (Ctrl+C) and restart with:

```
claudia --model small
```

Replace “small” with any model name from the table above.

9. Using Cloud Transcription (Optional)

By default, Claudia processes your voice entirely on your Mac. Nothing leaves your computer. But if you want even faster and more accurate results, you can use a cloud service called Groq.

What is Groq? Groq is a company that runs the Whisper speech model on super-fast special chips. It transcribes speech 216 times faster than real-time — meaning a 10-second recording is transcribed in about 0.05 seconds. It’s essentially instant.

How to set it up:

Step 1: Go to console.groq.com and create a free account.

Step 2: Create an API key (a long secret code that proves it’s you).

Step 3: In Terminal, type this (replacing your-key-here with your actual key):

```
export CLAUDIA_GROQ_API_KEY=your-key-here
```

Step 4: Start Claudia with the cloud engine:

```
claudia --engine groq
```

Privacy Note

When using Groq, your voice recordings are sent over the internet to Groq's servers for transcription. If privacy is important to you, stick with the default local mode.

10. Changing Your Settings

Claudia saves your settings in a small file on your computer. You can find it here:

```
~/.claudia/config.json
```

You can open this file in any text editor (like TextEdit) and change the values. Here's what each setting does:

Transcription Settings

Setting	What It Controls	Options
engine	Where transcription happens	"local" (your Mac) or "groq" (cloud)
model_size	Which Whisper model to use	"tiny", "base", "small", "medium", "large-v3"
language	What language you speak	"en" (English), "fr", "de", "es", "ja", etc.
groq_api_key	Your Groq API key (if using cloud)	Your key string, or null

User Interface Settings

Setting	What It Controls	Options
show_floating_widget	Show the floating mic button?	true or false
play_chime	Play a sound when transcription finishes?	true or false
auto_paste	Automatically paste text into the active app?	true or false
widget_x / widget_y	Where the floating button appears on screen	Numbers (pixels from top-left corner)

Quick Way to Change Settings

You can also change settings using commands when you start Claudia, without editing the file. For example: `claudia --model small --no-chime --language fr`

11. All the Commands You Can Type

Here is every command you can use when starting Claudia in Terminal:

Command	What It Does
---------	--------------

<code>claudia</code>	Start Claudia with default settings
<code>claudia --devices</code>	Show a list of all your microphones
<code>claudia --device 2</code>	Use a specific microphone (number from <code>--devices</code> list)
<code>claudia --model tiny</code>	Use the tiny (fastest) Whisper model
<code>claudia --model small</code>	Use the small (more accurate) Whisper model
<code>claudia --engine groq</code>	Use Groq cloud instead of local Whisper
<code>claudia --groq-key YOUR_KEY</code>	Provide your Groq API key
<code>claudia --language es</code>	Transcribe in Spanish (or any language code)
<code>claudia --language auto</code>	Auto-detect what language you're speaking
<code>claudia --no-widget</code>	Don't show the floating mic button (menubar only)
<code>claudia --no-paste</code>	Don't auto-paste (just copy text to clipboard)
<code>claudia --no-chime</code>	Don't play the chime sound after transcription
<code>claudia --setup</code>	Run the first-time setup wizard again
<code>claudia --version</code>	Show what version of Claudia you have
<code>claudia -v</code>	Show detailed debug messages (for troubleshooting)
<code>claudia --help</code>	Show all available commands

12. Troubleshooting — When Things Go Wrong

Here are the most common problems and how to fix them:

Problem: "Auto-paste failed" message

What happened: Claudia could not press Cmd+V on your behalf because it doesn't have Accessibility permission.

Fix: Go to System Settings > Privacy & Security > Accessibility. Make sure your Terminal app is in the list and the toggle is ON. Then restart Claudia.

Your text is still on the clipboard! You can press Cmd+V yourself to paste it.

Problem: "No input devices found"

What happened: Claudia can't find your microphone because the portaudio library is missing.

Fix: In Terminal, type: `brew install portaudio` — then restart Claudia.

Problem: Transcription is very slow

Fix: Try a smaller model: `claudia --model tiny`. Or switch to cloud: `claudia --engine groq`. Apple Silicon Macs (M1/M2/M3/M4) are much faster than Intel Macs.

Problem: Text appears in the wrong window

What happened: You clicked on a different window while Claudia was transcribing (blue phase). The text was pasted into whatever window was in front.

Fix: Before clicking the mic, click on the text box where you want your words to appear. After clicking the mic and speaking, don't click anywhere else until the text appears.

Problem: Claudia doesn't hear me / transcribes silence

Fix: Check that your microphone is working. Open System Settings > Sound > Input and speak — you should see the level bar move. If it doesn't, select the correct input device. Then tell Claudia which device to use: `claudia --devices` to see the list, then `claudia --device 2` (use the number of your working mic).

Problem: "pip: command not found"

Fix: Try `pip3 install claudia-chatterley` instead of `pip`. If that also fails, install Python with: `brew install python@3.12`

Problem: "command not found: brew"

What happened: Homebrew is not installed on your Mac. Most Macs don't come with it.

Fix: Run the smart installer from Chapter 3 (Option A). It will install Homebrew for you. Or install Homebrew manually by pasting this into Terminal:

```
/bin/bash -c "$(curl -fsSL
https://raw.githubusercontent.com/Homebrew/install/HEAD/install.sh)"
```

After installing, close Terminal and open a new window for the brew command to work.

Problem: "Python 3.10+ required (found 3.9)"

What happened: Your Mac has an older version of Python that came pre-installed with macOS. Claudia needs a newer version.

Fix: Install a newer Python with: `brew install python@3.12`. This does NOT replace your old Python — it adds a new one alongside it. Then restart Claudia.

13. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Does Claudia send my voice to the internet?

A: Not by default. In local mode (the default), everything stays on your Mac. Only if you choose to use Groq cloud mode does audio leave your computer.

Q: Does Claudia work in apps other than Cowork?

A: Yes! Claudia works in any app on your Mac — Chrome, Safari, Notes, Word, Slack, Terminal, anything that accepts text. It works at the operating system level, not inside any single app.

Q: Can Claudia understand languages other than English?

A: Yes. Whisper supports dozens of languages. Use `claudia --language es` for Spanish, `--language fr` for French, `--language de` for German, and so on. Use `--language auto` to let Claudia figure out what language you're speaking.

Q: Can I use Claudia while on a Zoom call?

A: Yes, but make sure Claudia is using the right microphone. Use `claudia --devices` to see your microphones, and `claudia --device N` to pick one that isn't your Zoom microphone.

Q: How much does Claudia cost?

A: Claudia is 100% free and open source under the MIT License. Groq's cloud API has a free tier; check their website for current limits.

Q: Does it work on Windows or Linux?

A: Claudia is designed for macOS. The transcription engine will work on other platforms, but the floating widget and auto-paste features are macOS-specific. Cross-platform support may come in a future version.

Q: Why is it called “Claudia Chatterley”?

A: The author, Severin Sorensen, has affectionately called Claude “Claudia Chatterley” for years — keeping the naming tradition he started with “Amelia Chatterley” for ChatGPT. Every good AI deserves a proper name.

14. What’s Coming Next (Roadmap)

Version	Feature	Status
v0.1	Voice-to-text with floating mic widget	Available now
v0.2	Global hotkey support (Cmd+Shift+Space)	Planned
v0.3	Cowork plugin integration (MCP server)	Planned
v0.4	Two-way voice conversation (Claudia speaks back!)	Planned
v0.5	Voice selection (accent, gender, speed)	Planned
v1.0	Stable release with full Cowork plugin	Planned

15. Glossary — Words You Might Not Know

Here are some technical words used in this manual, explained simply:

Word	What It Means
API Key	A secret password that lets one program talk to another program over the internet.
Clipboard	The invisible holding area on your computer where text goes when you Copy (Cmd+C).
Cmd+V	The keyboard shortcut for Paste on a Mac. Hold the Command key and press V.
Groq	A company that runs speech-recognition software very fast in the cloud.
Homebrew	A free tool that helps you install programs on your Mac using Terminal.
Local	Happening on your own computer, not on the internet. Private and fast.
Menu bar	The narrow strip at the very top of your Mac screen with the Apple logo, clock, etc.
MIT License	A legal rule that says anyone can use, copy, and share this software for free.
Open Source	Software whose code is public so anyone can see it, use it, and improve it.
pip	A tool that downloads and installs Python programs from the internet.
portaudio	A small helper program that lets other programs (like Claudia) use your microphone.
Python	A popular programming language. Claudia is written in Python.
Terminal	An app on your Mac where you type commands instead of clicking buttons.
Transcription	The process of turning spoken words into written text.
VAD	Voice Activity Detection — Claudia's ability to know when you're speaking vs. silent.
Whisper	A speech-recognition program made by OpenAI. Claudia uses it to understand your voice.
Widget	A small, always-visible element on screen (like the floating microphone button).

Thank you for using Claudia Chatterley!

Speak freely. Let your ideas flow. Claudia will catch every word.

GitHub: github.com/severinsorensen/claudia-chatterley

Questions? Email: sev@epraxis.com